

Starting the Geofence Task Reminder App Locally

A step-by-step guide for running all three services (PHP, Python, React) on your development machine.

Step 1 — Start XAMPP (Apache + MySQL)

- 1 Open the **XAMPP Control Panel**.
- 2 Click **Start** next to **Apache**.
- 3 Click **Start** next to **MySQL**.
- 4 Both should show a green “Running” status before continuing.

Step 2 — Start the Python Flask Backend

Open a terminal window and run:

```
cd e:\project\geofence_project\backend-python
venv\Scripts\activate
python app.py
```

Leave this terminal open. You should see a line similar to **Running on http://127.0.0.1:5000**.

Step 3 — Start the React Frontend

Open a **second, separate** terminal window (do not close the Flask one):

```
cd e:\project\geofence_project\frontend-react
npm run dev
```

Leave this terminal open too. It will show a local URL, typically **http://localhost:5173**.

Step 4 — Open the Site

In your browser, go to:

```
http://localhost:5173
```

Step 5 — Confirm Everything Is Connected

- 1 **Log in** — this talks to the **PHP backend** via Apache/XAMPP.
- 2 Enable **Live Tracking** — this talks to the **Python Flask backend** on port 5000.
- 3 Both should work without CORS errors or an “Invalid session” message if everything is running correctly.

Quick Reference — What Must Stay Running

Service	How to Start It	Port
Apache (PHP)	XAMPP Control Panel	80
MySQL	XAMPP Control Panel	3306
Flask (Python)	python app.py	5000
Vite (React)	npm run dev	5173

Tip: Start things in this order — XAMPP first, then Flask, then React. Starting them out of order is a common cause of connection errors when the app first loads.